

Gain Clarity with Intellectual Integrity: The Foundation of Great Leadership

How to Prevent Conflicts, Eliminate Errors, and Maximize Revenue

Organized by Vyacheslav Ladischenski (Slava)



Agenda

1. Introductions
2. Presentation of the Problem
3. Discussion of the Problem
4. Presentation of the Solution
6. Discussion of the Solution
7. Conclusion

15 seconds Introductions

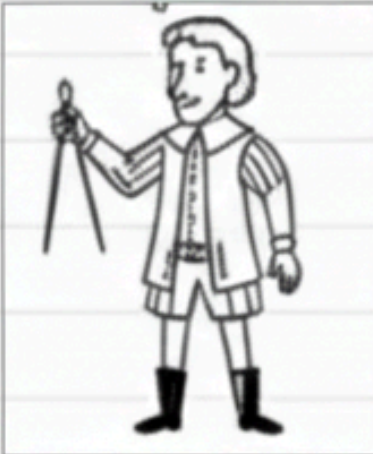
1. Your Name
2. What is your biggest expertise or unique knowledge?
3. What do you hope to achieve in this session?

Clarity

Clarity is the procedure that replaces an **assumption of understanding** with a **verification of understanding**.

It is often the pre-requisite to correcting **false beliefs**.

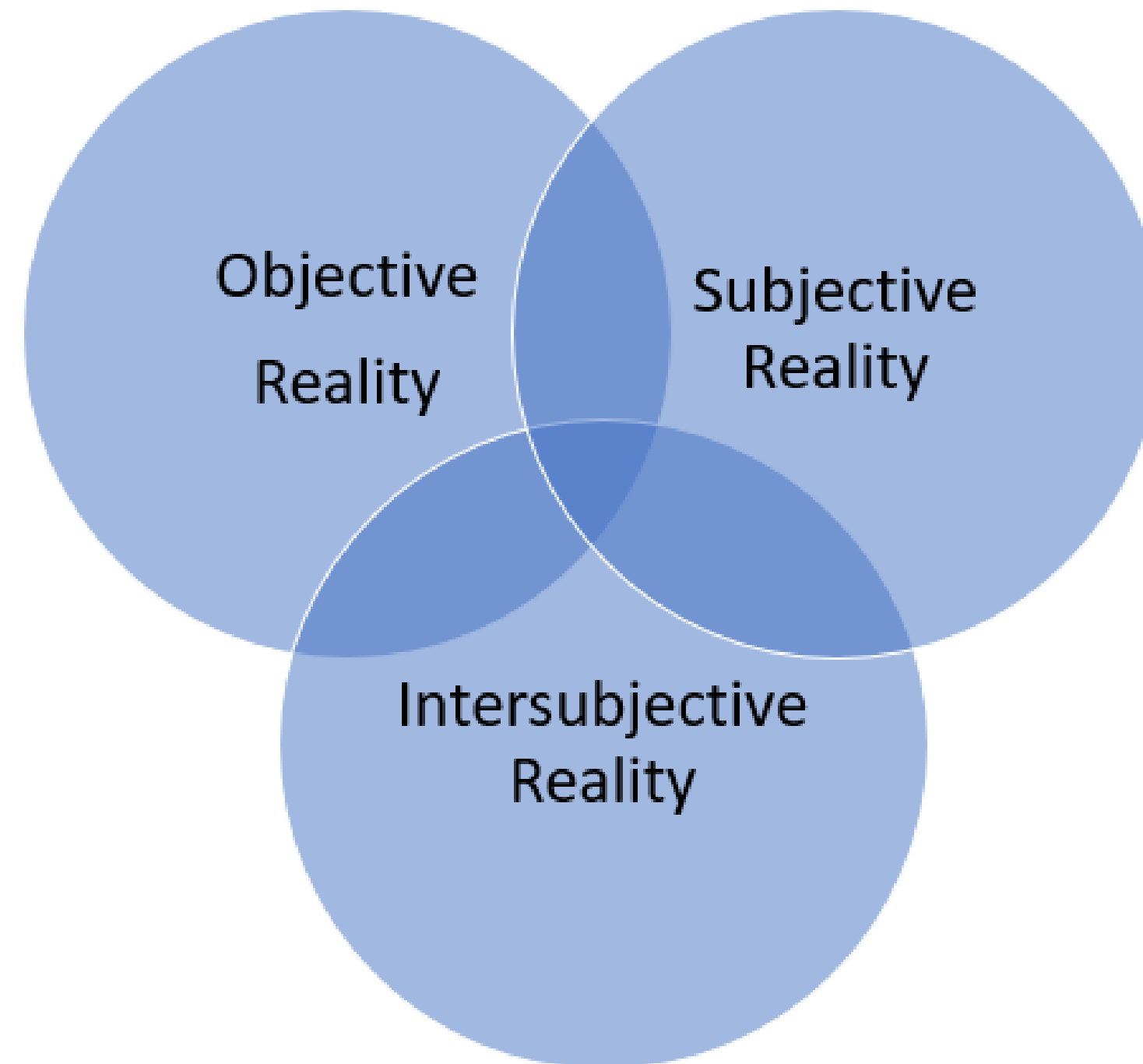
What is a False Belief?

Earth is center of universe.	Sun is center of universe.	Orbits are ellipses.	Gravity governs all motion.	Reality is curved specetime.	Beliefs
					
Ptolemy	Kopernikus	Kepler	Newton	Einstein	OBJECTIVE REALITY miro

Intellectual Integrity

Intellectual integrity is the commitment to prioritize the **correction** of one's own **false beliefs** when confronted with superior evidence, choosing **objective reality** over personal emotions, group loyalty, biases, or financial interests.

What is an Objective Reality?



Problem

Failure to correct **false beliefs**
prevents us from reaching long-term
goals, fulfilling our values, and solving
complex problems

The Root Cause

When a person refuses to repeat back your message in their own words,
they fail to build Common Knowledge, leaving their False Beliefs
uncorrected.

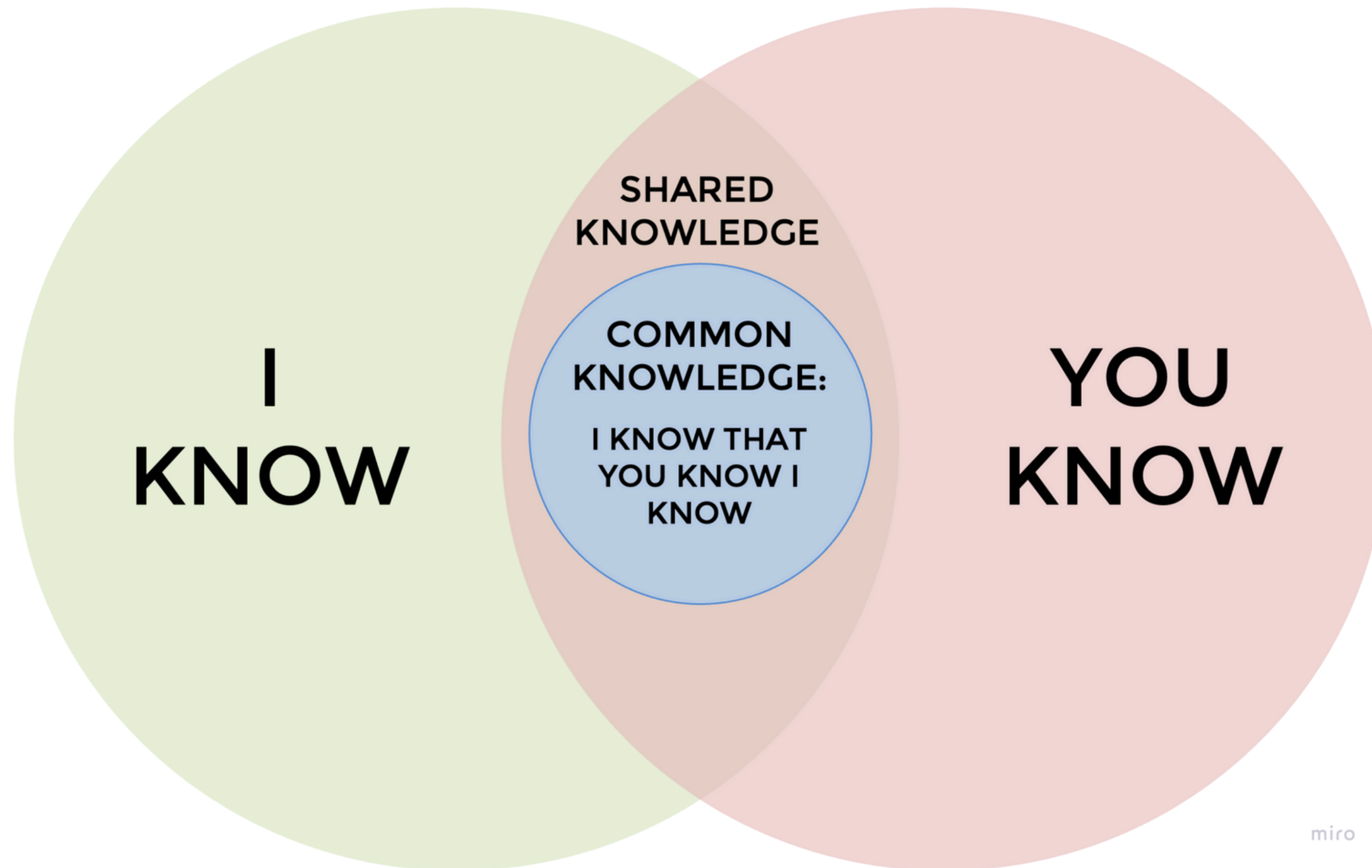
The Root Cause

"Ideally, we would all remain endlessly curious, constantly checking our assumptions. But we are human. We get tired, we get confident, and we fall victim to the illusion that we already know.

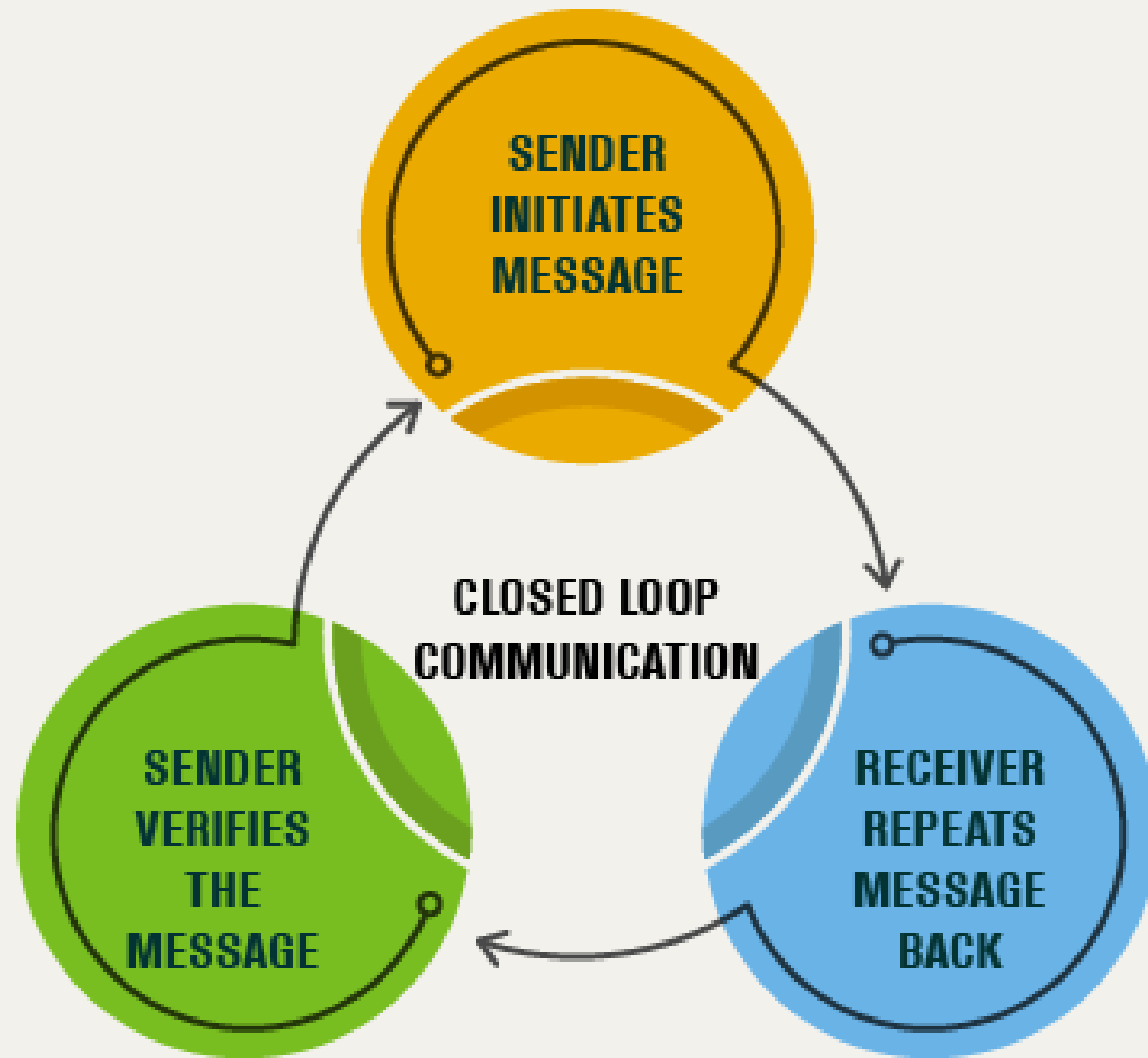
> We cannot rely on the feeling of curiosity to save us from coordination failure. We need a protocol—The Clarity Principle—that ensures we do the work of verification, even when our curiosity is asleep.

The Clarity Principle acts as a "Curiosity Prosthetic." It artificially injects the necessary inquiry into a conversation when natural curiosity has failed due to cognitive bias or social pressure.

What is Common Knowledge?

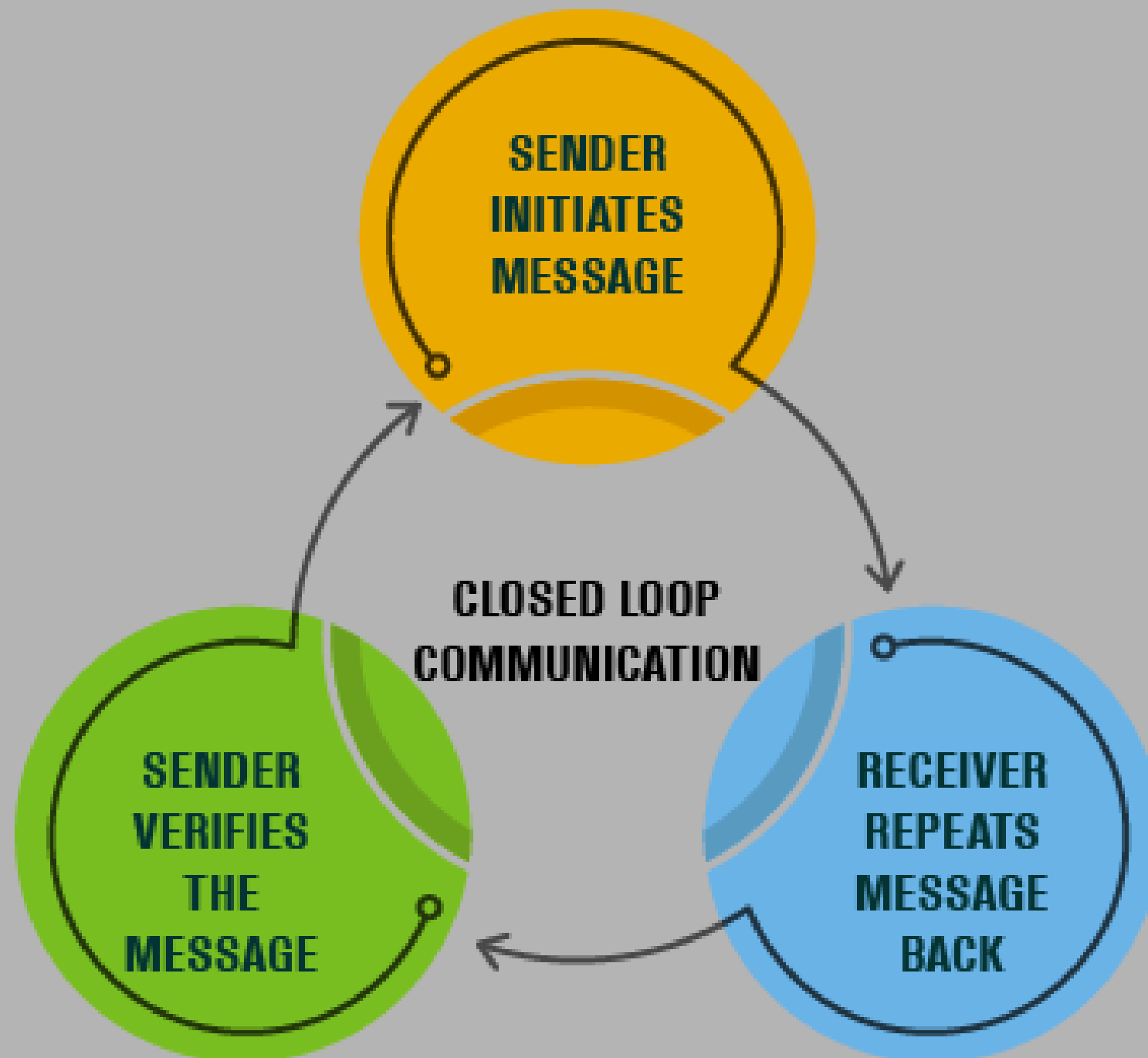


Closed-Loop Communication (CLC)



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- Aviation: Avoids Catastrophic Accidents
- Medicine: 47% fewer complications,
- Psychotherapy: #1 success predictor
- Complex Sales: Top Skill to Influence Customers
- Leadership: Ensures Psychological Safety for Team

What is the benefit of refusing to repeat the message back?



EGO

avoids taking the risk of exposing a potential error in understanding, which is driven by **Fear** of appearing incompetent.

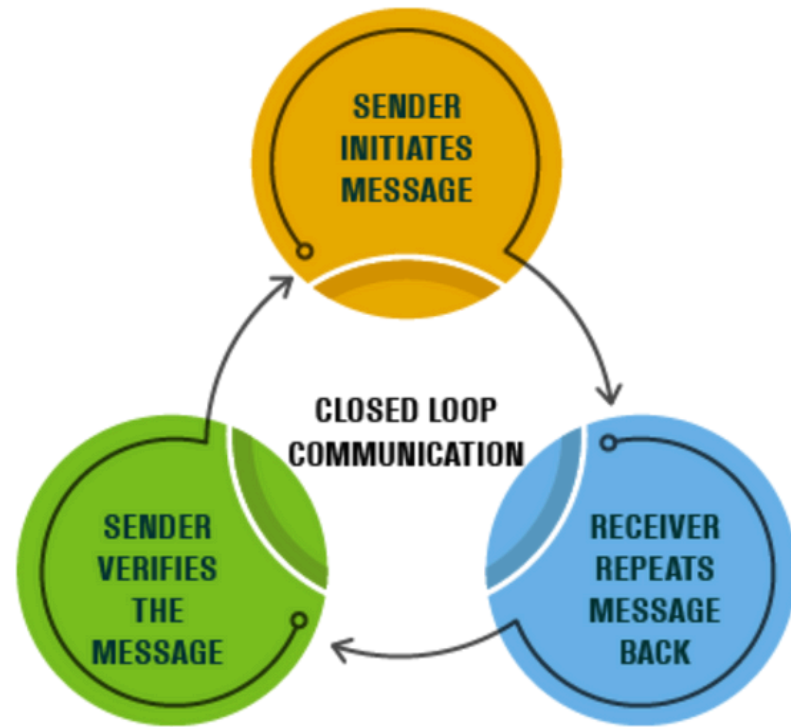
LAZINESS

avoids effort and skips the mental work required for active listening and clarification

FEAR

shifts accountability to preserve the opportunity to blame the partner for unclear communication, which is driven by strategic **Self-preservation**.

Problem



Refusing to use CLC



**Prevents building
Common Knowledge**



**Failure to Correct
False Beliefs**



**Failure in solving
problems**

Clarity Promise/Pledge

When we are in conversation and you need to check how I understood your idea, please ask me to repeat it in my own words. I will try to state it back without judgment or criticism, so you can confirm or correct my understanding. If I'm unable to repeat it back, I will explain why.

Benefits of Promise

PERSONAL

- Create psychological safety
- Improve relationships
- Prevent conflicts

BUSINESS

- Eliminate Errors
- Reduce Rework
- Increase Trust & Sales

SYSTEMIC

- Improve knowledge exchange
- Increase Problem-Solving Capacity
- Champion Intellectual Integrity

Group Discussion

Which political or business leader would you choose and why?

1. A leader who **is very skilled** and **actively refuses** to make the following promise to you
2. A leader who **is 60% skilled** and makes a **promise only** to a selected group of people
3. A leader who **is 55% skilled** and makes a **public pledge to everybody**, including his people, he doesn't know, dislikes or disagrees

When we are in a conversation, and you would like to verify my understanding, please don't hesitate to ask me to repeat your message. I will try to repeat it back without judgment or criticism. If I can't repeat back your message, I will clearly say why.

Intellectual Integrity Rapid Test

*When we are in a conversation, and you would like to verify my understanding, please don't hesitate to ask me to repeat your message. I will try to repeat it back without judgment or criticism.
If I can't repeat back your message, I will clearly say why.*

Level 0 - Skeptic - Lack of Will

Level 1 - Practitioner - Lack of Skill

Level 2 - Committed - Limited Will - Makes Private Promise(s).

Level 3 - Advocate - Full Will - Makes a Public Pledge.

To activate your benefits
register on the platform



Please take 1 min to
share your Feedback



Clarity: The Foundation of Great Leadership and Teams

How to Prevent Conflicts, Eliminate Errors, and Maximize Revenue

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Intellectual Integrity: The Foundation of Great Leadership and Teams

How to Prevent Conflicts, Eliminate Errors, and Maximize Revenue

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Group Discussion

Which political or business leader would you choose and why?

1. A leader **who is very skilled** and who has a **broken** corrective feedback loop
2. A leader **who is 60% skilled** and has a **working** corrective feedback loop

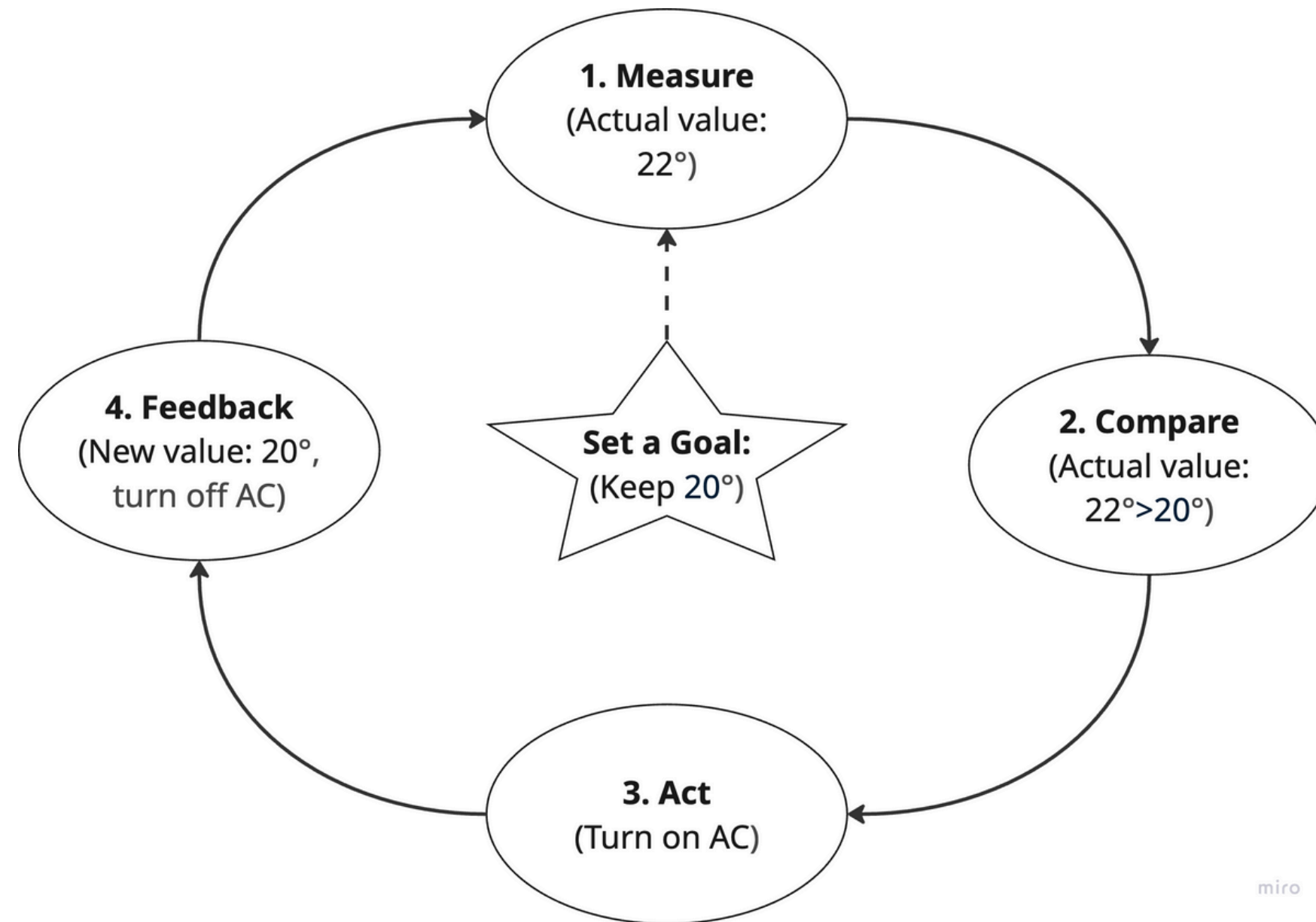
Key Takeaway

Solving complex problems is the Destination.

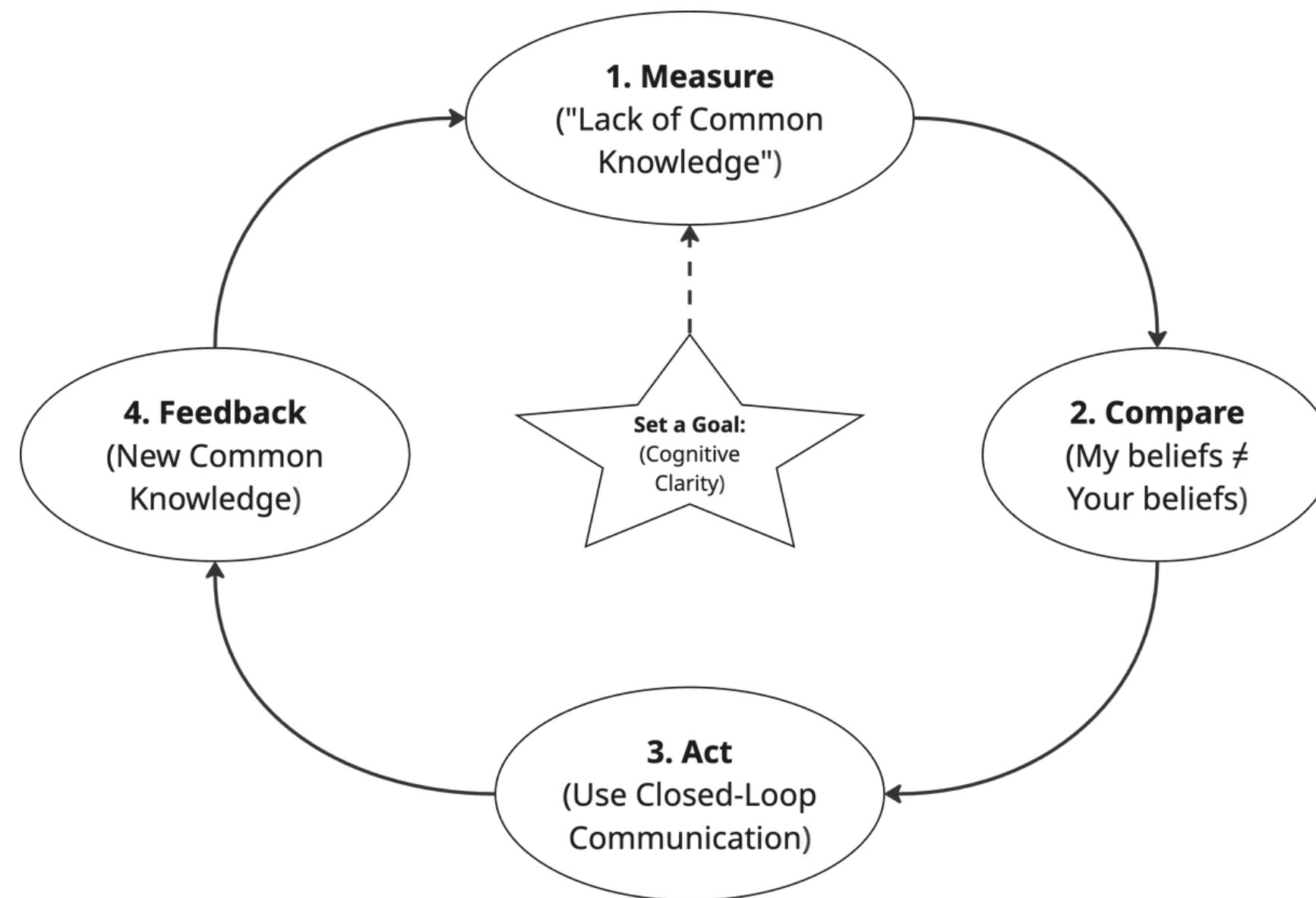
Intellectual Integrity is the Way.

It's hard to get to the destination if you don't know the way.

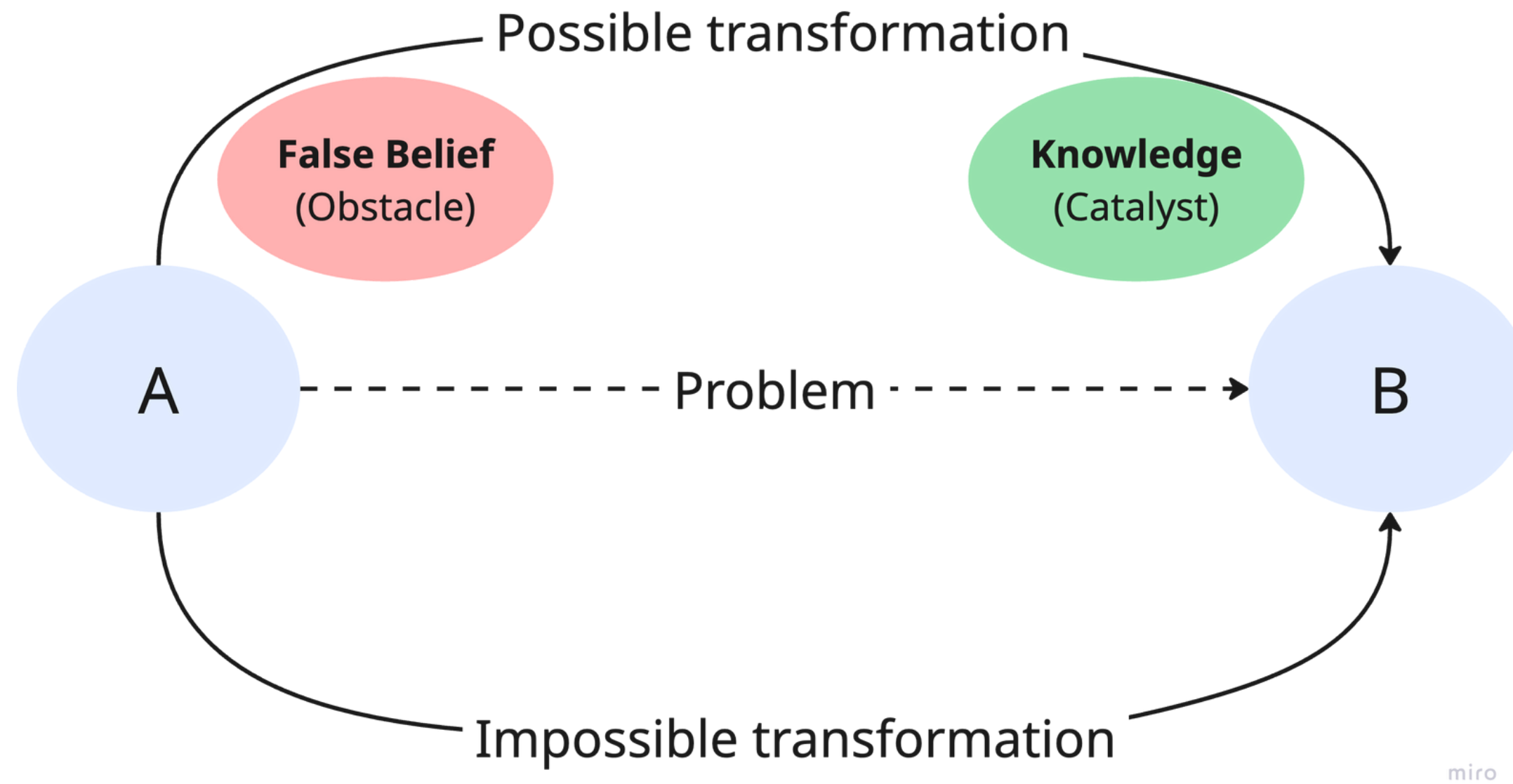
What is a Corrective Feedback Loop?



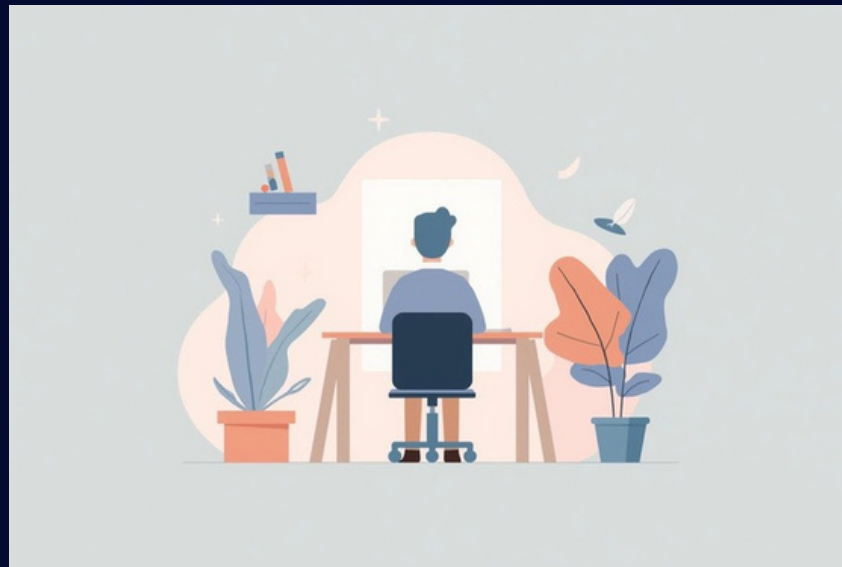
Corrective Feedback Loop in Interpersonal Communication



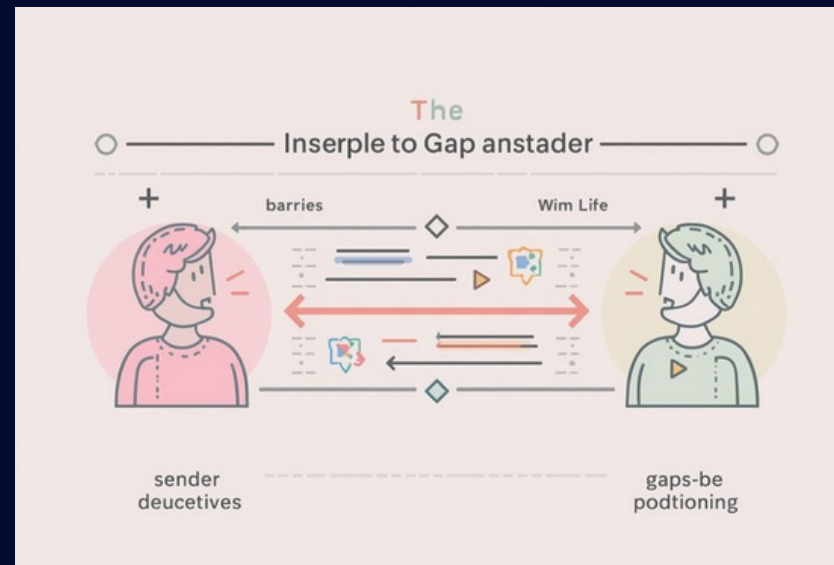
How False Beliefs lead to failure in solving problems?



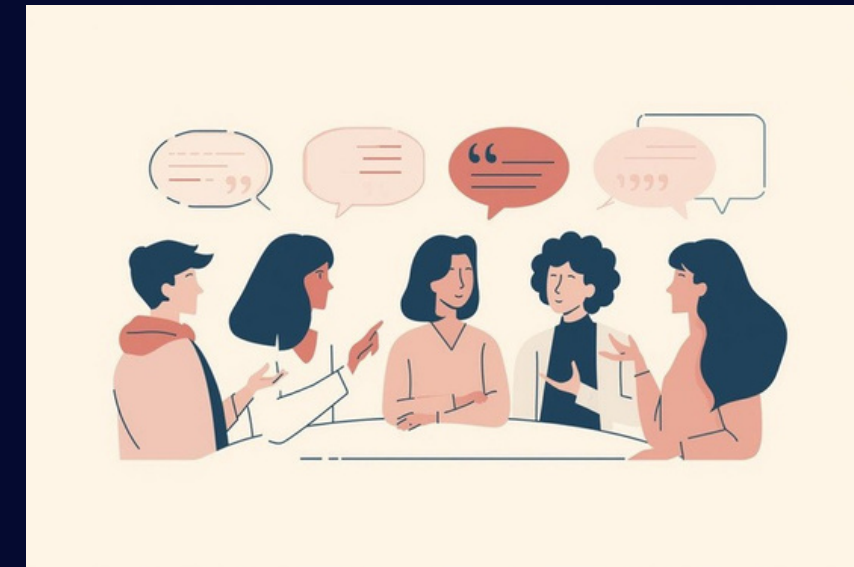
How Intellectual Integrity Promise fixes broken CFL?



HELPS TO
SPEAK UP



HELPS TO UNDERSTAND



HELPS TO MAKE RIGHT
CONCLUSIONS

How big is the problem?

80%

of leaders believe
they are understood

50%

of employees agree they
truly understand

44%

of employees withhold
sharing their
disagreements

\$1.2T

broken
communication cost
annually in U.S.
economic losses

Consequences of the Problem

Individual

- Relationships break
- Conflicts escalate
- Mistrust grows

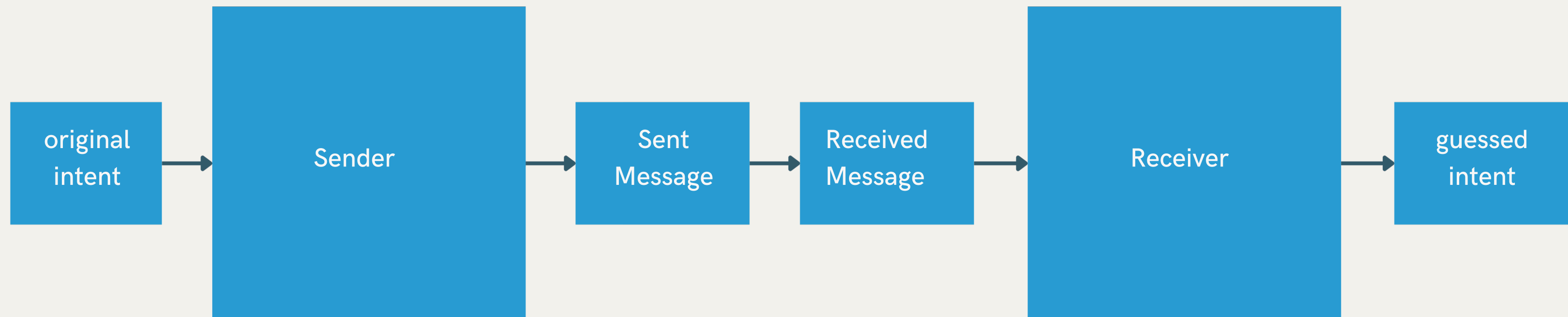
Organizational

- More critical mistakes
- Lots of Rework
- Negative impact on revenue

Societal

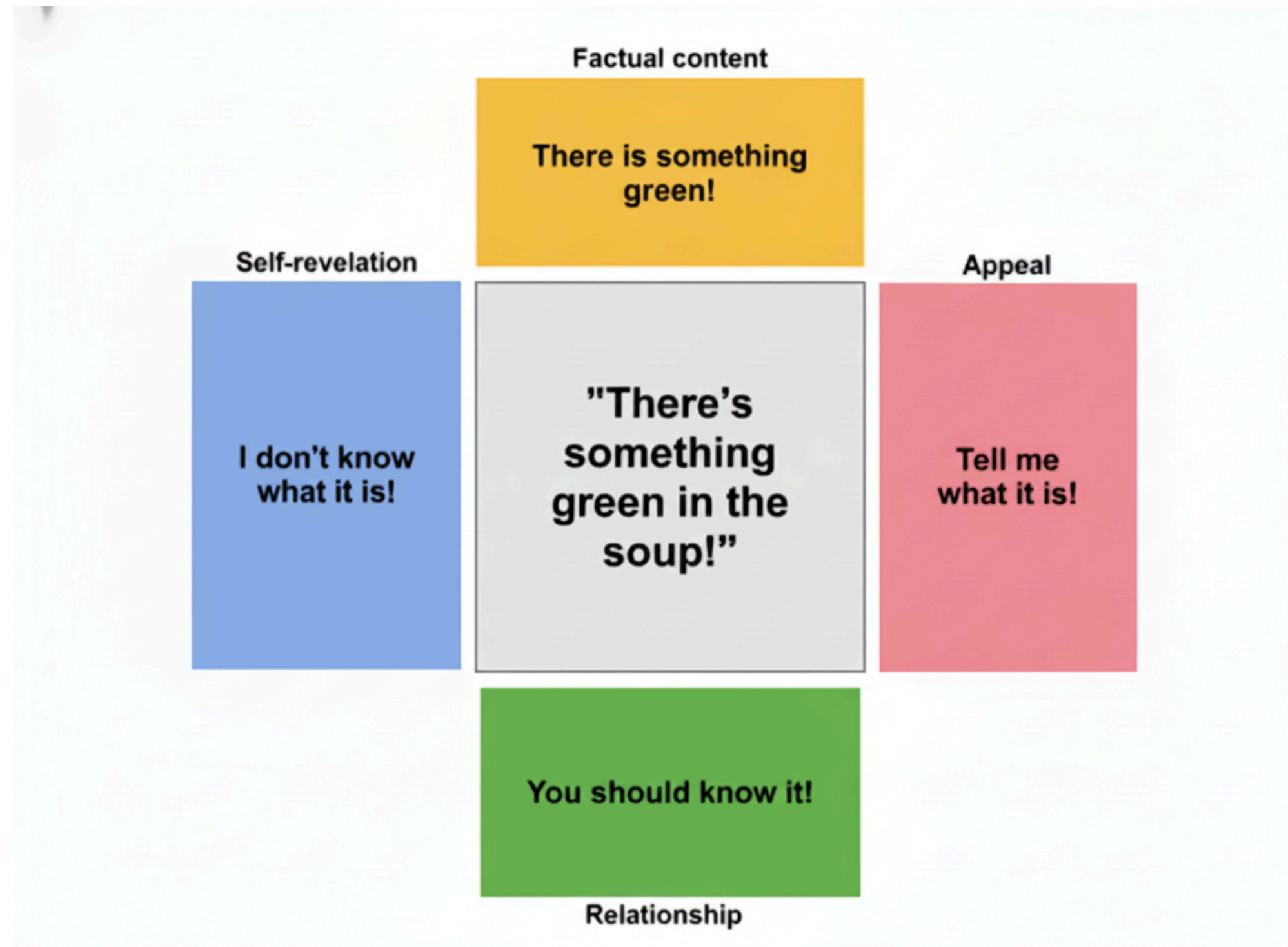
- Ideological Polarization
- Loss of Shared Reality
- Decreased Problem-Solving Capacity

What is Illusion of Understanding?



Sender-Receiver Communication Model

Why is guessing intent hard?



How CLC Fails

ASYMMETRY OF ROLES

Everyone can speak as much as they want

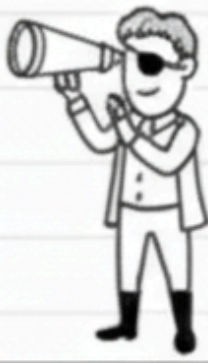
ASYMMETRY OF INFORMATION

Listener judges understanding of the speaker's intent based on their intuition

ASYMMETRY OF VULNERABILITY

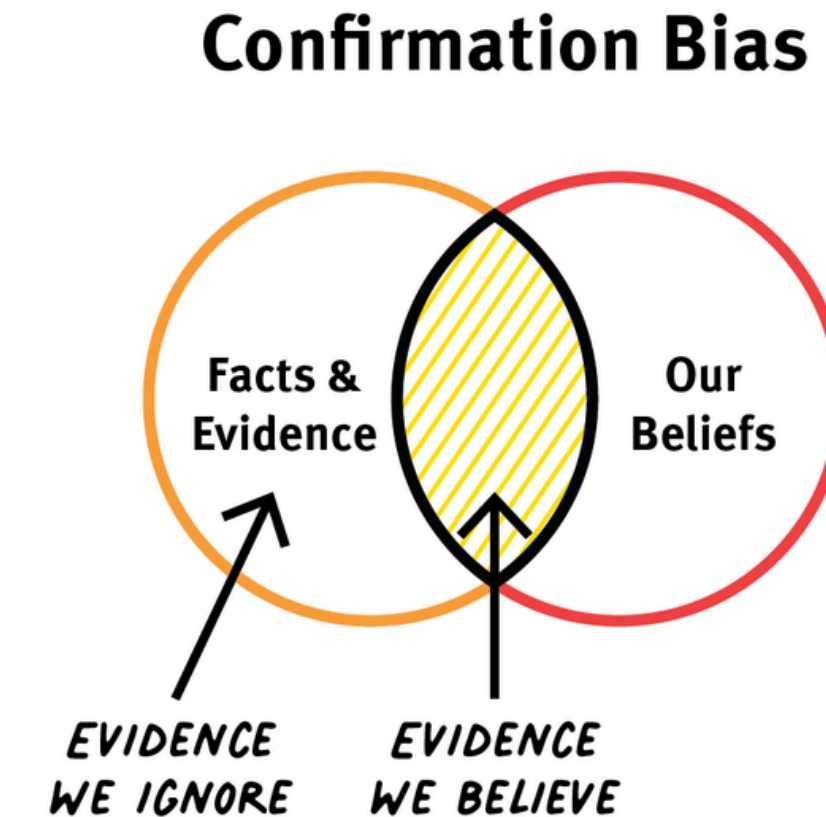
The listener fails to regulate their emotions and this silences the speaker

How Intellectual Integrity Promise helps to make right conclusions?

Dogmatism	Rationalism	Empiricism	Pragmatism	Critical Rationalism	Epistemology
I know because my intuition confirms it	I know because my reason confirm it.	I know because my observations confirm it	I know because it works	I don't know, but this is my current best theory because it withstood all attempts to prove it wrong.	Rules to justify Valid Explanations
Because all our ancestors can't be wrong	It's simpler mathematical solution	Precise observations proved Kopernikus wrong	It predicts the motion of both apples and planets!	Newtons laws don't work with the speed of light	Explanations
Earth is center of universe.	Sun is center of universe.	Orbits are ellipses.	Gravity governs all motion.	Reality is curved specetime.	Beliefs
					 OBJECTIVE REALITY
Ptolemy	Kopernikus	Kepler	Newton	Einstein	

Why is CFL broken?

- A cognitive bias is a **mental shortcut** our brain evolved to process information quickly.
- It leads to **predictable errors** in judgment.
- There are **220+** biases!



Join Problem-Solving Practice Community



Why your Intellectual Integrity Promise is important?

1. Problems are inevitable.
 2. One of the main obstacles to solving problems is false beliefs about cause-and-effect (i.e., how the world actually works).
 3. The reason false beliefs persist is the willful refusal to engage the corrective feedback loop (low intellectual integrity).
 4. When this feedback loop breaks, it causes a decline in problem-solving capacity, leaving critical problems unsolved.
 5. Prioritizing the comfort of a false belief over objective reality is self-defeating, as the individual cannot escape the severe consequences of a failing society.
- The Solution: Championing Intellectual Integrity is a necessary condition to fix the corrective feedback loop and build the Societal Resilience required to solve complex problems and ultimately secure the individual's own well-being.

Philosophy and mission

1. Problems are inevitable.
2. The core barrier to solving problems is often action based on false knowledge.
3. It's easier to spot the false knowledge in others than in yourself.
4. The reason why false knowledge persists is often because of the broken feedback loop.
5. When the corrective feedback loop is broken, we suffer from the consequences of our growing problems.

Our mission is to fix broken feedback loops and make full collective alignment easier to attain because it helps solve problems and avoid suffering from their consequences.

Build new habits with an armband

Move the armband when:

1. You paraphrase
2. The Speaker confirms it as accurate

The Five Knowledge Constructors



Solution

Cognitive Clarity Communication (CCC) is a communication framework that makes it easier for people to fix the broken corrective feedback loop:

1. It helps resolve three types of asymmetries.
2. It aids groups in building common knowledge
3. It makes reaching full alignment possible.

#1 CCC: Agree on a shared goal

Cognitive clarity is a prerequisite for fully aligned agreement.

Emotionally validate the perceived impact on your conversation partner, proposing cognitive clarity as a mutual goal.

#2 CCC: Prepare your critical feedback in advance

As Speaker, when you feel a possible disagreement, you can use I-statements.

Before using You-Statements, ask for permission to give feedback and leverage Non-violent communication to phrase your message.

#3 CCC: Pay attention to cues to listen

Propose how your conversation partner can bring you into a listener role - e.g. by asking you to paraphrase the intent of their message.

#4 CCC: Acknowledge your fallability

..

#5 CCC: As Listener practice emotional self-Regulation

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Group Discussion

Topic: How clear and valuable are the 5 rules of Cognitive Clarity Communication (CCC)?

Move the armband when:

1. You paraphrase
2. The Speaker confirms it as accurate

Negative Externality

It is the systemic cost when an actor(s) action impose a negative outcome on its environment.